

The Sleeping Garden

The Floating Isles are islands adrift in a calm sky, in a realm where magic only ever helps: it grows, it heals, it changes one thing into another, and it lets you speak with animals and objects. It never harms. On the home island, the House of the Little Mages sits at the highest point, where young mages learn their first spells, and the city where the families live spreads below. Inside the school grounds lies the Great Garden, the green heart of the whole island. Here nobody loses; you find your way by being clever and kind.



The Sleeping Garden

A magical adventure map

How to use the map

- Put a small figure on each white circle (that is you).
- The golden path leads you from 1 to 4, solving each puzzle.

Build the objects from bricks.

START

Begin here

1

The Vine Gate

2

The Flower Bed

3

The Talking Fountain



The Heart of the Garden
GOAL

The Sleeping Garden

Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only new ideas to try.

Before you begin

This morning you wake up and the whole island is quiet. Too quiet. You look out of the window of the House of the Little Mages. The Great Garden is grey and still, as if it has fallen asleep. The flowers are shut. The fountain makes no sound.

You are two little mages. You pick up your bag. You look at each other. "Let us go and wake it up," you say together. The golden path is waiting.

What is your mage name? Which magic do you choose: Light, Grow, Change, or Voice?

Stop 1: The Vine Gate

You come to a tall gate. Green vines have tied it shut with a big knot of leaves. The gate will not open.

A soft grey cat steps out of the mist. It is the Mist Cat. It purrs and looks at the knot, then at you. It seems to want to help.

How do you open the way? Could a magic make a gap? Could you ask the vines kindly to move? Try something and see.

When the gate swings open, the first sleepy flower opens one petal. The garden is waking, just a little.

Stop 2: The Flower Bed

Now you reach a bed of flowers. Four of them have drooped and lost their order. A tiny voice hums a little rhyme: "First the sun, then the sea, then the berry, then fly free."

The flowers want to stand in the right colours, but they have forgotten how.

Which colour is the sun? Which is the sea? Can you set the four flowers in the order the rhyme sings?

When the flowers stand in their order, they open wide and turn their faces up. Two more corners of the garden turn green again.

Stop 3: The Talking Fountain

You come to a stone fountain. It is not singing. It is not even dripping. The water sits still and grey, and the fountain looks a little sad. You lean close. "Hello?" you whisper. The fountain sighs. It wants to feel happy again.

What could you do to cheer it up? Maybe a song. Maybe a joke. Maybe a kind word. What do you try?

When the fountain feels happy, the water leaps up and sparkles. It begins to sing again. Now only the very heart of the garden is still asleep.

The Heart of the Garden

At the centre of the garden you find a small, sad sprite curled up tight. It was the sprite who sent the garden to sleep. Not to be unkind. It was only lonely, and it did not know how to ask for a friend.

There is no fight here. There never was a real villain.

What do you say to the sprite? How can you show it that it is not alone?

When you offer the sprite your friendship, it smiles for the first time in a long while. All around you, the Great Garden wakes up at once: flowers open, the fountain sings, and the island is bright and warm again.

You did it together. You were clever, and you were kind. Well done.

The Story in Pictures



A tall gate tied shut with a knot of green vines, the Mist Cat watching nearby.



A flower bed of four big flowers in yellow, blue, red and white, slightly out of order.



A quiet stone fountain beginning to sparkle and flow again.



The garden's heart waking, the shy sprite smiling as two little mages offer friendship, flowers opening in golden light.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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